SCHEDULE RECONCILIATION PROPOSAL

TO: Ege & Celine (Management)
FROM: Kitchen Staff Team
DATE: December 2026 Trial Period
SUBJECT: **Operational Schedule Alignment & Attendance Framework**

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & LEGAL CONTEXT

We welcome management's trial schedule for December 2026, granting two consecutive rest days (Wednesdays & Thursdays). To ensure transparent operation during this trial, we present this proposal aligning real kitchen working hours with statutory standards under the Portuguese Labor Code (*Código do Trabalho*).

2. SHIFT BREAKDOWN UNDER VARYING OPERATIONAL CONDITIONS

Work starts with daily prep (11:00 or 11:45 AM) and finishes following service shutdown (23:30). Overtime is calculated against the legal standard of 40 hours per week (*Art. 198 Código do Trabalho*):

DAY	STANDARD BASELINE	BUSY CONDITIONS (LATE / HIGH VOL)	PEAK / HEAVY PREP & EVENTS
Monday	10.5 hrs (11:45–16:00 / 18:00–23:30)	11.25 hrs (11:00 prep / exit ~23:45)	12.0 hrs (11:00 prep / exit ~00:00)
Tuesday	5.0 hrs (11:45–16:00 + clean)	6.0 hrs (Extended stock & deep clean)	6.5 hrs (Full inventory & audit)
Wednesday	CLOSED (0.0 hrs)	CLOSED (0.0 hrs)	CLOSED (0.0 hrs)
Thursday	CLOSED (0.0 hrs)	CLOSED (0.0 hrs)	CLOSED (0.0 hrs)
Friday	10.5 hrs (11:45–16:00 / 18:00–23:30)	11.25 hrs (11:00 prep / exit ~23:45)	12.0 hrs (11:00 prep / exit ~00:00)
Saturday	10.5 hrs (11:45–16:00 / 18:00–23:30)	11.5 hrs (Heavy dinner & late turn)	12.25 hrs (Peak turn & late exit)
Sunday	10.5 hrs (11:45–16:00 / 18:00–23:30)	11.25 hrs (11:00 prep / exit ~23:45)	12.0 hrs (Heavy prep & late finish)
TOTAL WEEKLY HOURS	**47.0 Hours**	**51.25 Hours**	**54.75 Hours**
STATUTORY OVERTIME (vs. 40h Legal Cap)	**+7.0 Hours Overtime**	**+11.25 Hours Overtime**	**+14.75 Hours Overtime**

3. KEY RECOMMENDATIONS & STATUTORY COMPLIANCE

- **Statutory 40-Hour Baseline & Overtime (*Arts. 198 & 268 Código do Trabalho*):** Under Portuguese law, the full-time standard work week is 40 hours. The proposed 47.0-hour baseline schedule inherently includes 7.0 hours of weekly overtime per employee, which increases to +11.25h or +14.75h under busy or peak operational conditions.
- **Synchronized Arrival Policy:** If all staff are scheduled for simultaneous shifts, all team members must arrive together at the designated prep time (11:00 or 11:45 AM) to ensure equal workload distribution during *mise en place*.
- **Attendance Tracking System (*Art. 202 Código do Trabalho*):** We propose implementing an automated digital clock-in system (app or panel) to record exact timestamps for arrival, mid-day breaks, and evening departures to accurately capture overtime hours.
- **Trial Evaluation Milestone:** Utilize the December trial to log objective time data, followed by a mid-trial check-in with management to review shift efficiency and reconcile accrued overtime balances.